A-A-53201
18 September 1987

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

FORCEPS, ARTHROSCOPIC (Straight)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This commercial item description covers ring-handled hook scissors arthroscopic forceps used in arthroscopic procedures. Both the hook scissors and the shaft shall be straight and be either 3.4 or 4.5 mm diameter and shall have a working length of 120 mm. The scissors jaws shall have no anterior, lateral, or medial pins.

Salient characteristics:

General. The definition of the terms and components used in this specification are in accordance with ASTM Standard F921. Performance shall be in accordance with applicable requirements of ASTM F1026.

Material. The arthroscopic forceps shall be fabricated of Class 3 or Class 4 corrosion-resistant steel in accordance with ASTM F899 as follows. The ring handles and scissors blades shall be Class 4. The shaft tube, shaft rod, and screws and pins shall be Class 3 or Class 4.

Hardness. The Rockwell hardness of the ring handles shall be C42 to C47 and the scissors blades shall be C48 to C53. The screw and pins shall be C38 to C42, if Class 4, and B75 minimum if Class 3. The shaft rod and shaft tube hardness shall be C40 to C47 if Class 4 and B75 minimum if Class 3.

Style, design and dimensions. The arthroscopic forceps shall be in strict accordance with Defense Personnel Support Center (DPSC) Drawing #22295.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515

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Finish. The finish of the arthroscopic forceps shall be mirror, satin or matte. The matte finish shall exhibit a uniform nondirectional surface texture equivalent to that produced by lightly blasting the prepared surface with fine abrasives under pressure.

Passivation. The arthroscopic forceps shall be properly passivated.

Corrosion-resistance. The arthroscopic forceps shall show no signs of corrosion or plating of copper when tested for corrosion-resistance as specified in Federal Specification GG-I-526.

Specific performance. The forceps shall operate smoothly and freely without binding. When closed, the action of the scissors blades shall be smooth and form a precise cutting edge. The mechanism shall be sufficiently tight to ensure correct alignment of the blades with no free-play. The forcpes shall be capable of cutting through a minimum of 0.042 inch of paper cleanly.

Identification markings. In addition to the requirements specified in ASTM F1026, the arthroscopic forceps shall also be marked "stainless".

Tests. Corrosion-resistance, hardness and performance shall be tested as specified under Quality Assurance Provisions.

Workmanship. The arthroscopic forceps shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Product Quality Level

Visual and dimensional examination. Shall be examined to verify that design, construction and workmanship are in accordance with applicable requirements.

Materials. The supplier shall be responsible for performing tests to assure that materials are in accordance with requirements specified.

Unit. Each (EA). One arthroscopic forceps, as specified, constitutes one unit.

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Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, and as specified herein. Unit of product for examination purposes shall be one forceps.

TABLE I. Sampling For Inspection.

Type of defect	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Major	II	1.0
Minor	II	4.0

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TABLE II. Classification of Defects.

Categories	Defects
Critical	None defined.
Major	
101	Forceps not free from cracks, pits, burs, sharp edges, scale, rough areas or corrosion.
102	Finish of the forceps not as specified.
103	Style and design not as specified.
Minor	
201	Identification markings not present, not complete, or not legible.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified below. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one forceps.

TABLE III. Sampling for Tests.

Characteristic	Requirement	Test Procedures	Inspection Level	AQL
Composition analysis	ASTM F899	Rqrmt's	*	0.0
Hardness test	Rqrmt's	ASTM E18,E92 & E140	S-2	1.0
Dimensions	Rqrmt's	------	S-1	2.5
Copper sulfate test	GG-I-526	GG-I-526	S-2	1.0
Boil test	GG-I-526	GG-I-526	S-2	1.0
Performance			S-2	1.0

Tests.

Corrosion resistance. The arthroscopic forceps shall be tested as specified in Federal Specification GG-I-526.

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Hardness. Hardness shall be tested in accordance with ASTM E18 or E92 whichever is applicable. Conversion of hardness values shall be in accordance with ASTM E140.

Performance. Performance shall be tested in accordance with applicable requirements of ASTM F1026.

Paper cutting test. Use a minimum 14 pieces of writing paper 0.003 inch thick to make the 0.042 inch minimum thickness. White tablet paper is an example. Paper should not fold. The scissors which cannot cut are rejected.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specification, standard, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

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COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION A-A-53201

NOTE: The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document:

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6515-01-139-7637	FORCEPS, ARTHROSCOPIC, Straight, 120 mm Long, 4.5 mm Hook Scissors
6515-01-165-9427	FORCEPS, ARTHROSCOPIC, Straight, 120 mm Long, 3.4 mm Hook Scissors

Ordering data (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6515-4102

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1 DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT TITLE

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b ADDRESS *(Street, City State ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)* _____

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6 REMARKS

7a NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8 DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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